

□ ARCHITECTURE IN ANCIENT INDIA — FULL MIND MAP

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1. Khajuraho Temples — Chandela Dynasty

- Khajuraho ke magnificent shrines Chandela dynasty ki architectural craftsmanship ka brilliant example hain — MP ke Chhatarpur region mein, mainly 10th-12th century ke beech banaye gaye. Inme se Kandariya Mahadeva shrine sabse spectacular maana jaata hai. [Q1, Q2, Q3, Q4]
- Khajuraho temples Hindu aur Jain — dono faiths ko dedicate hain. 950-1050 CE ke beech Chandela monarchs ne inhe banwaya, originally yahan ~85 sanctuaries the. [Q5, Q6]
- Matangeshvara Temple (Khajuraho complex ka hissa) Lord Shiva ko dedicate hai — King Dhanga ke time bana, aur Nagara architectural style ka prominent example hai. [Q7]
- Dashavatara Temple Khajuraho mein NAHI hai — ye Deogarh (Lalitpur) mein hai, Gupta era se belong karta hai. Kandariya Mahadev, Chausath Yogini aur Chitragupta temples — teeno Khajuraho mein hain, Chandela rulers ne banwaye. [Q8]
- Pairs check: Khajuraho Temple — Chandelas (sahi match). Ellora Caves — Rashtrakutas (Sakas NAHI). Meenakshi Temple — Pandyas (Pallavas NAHI). Mahabalipuram Temple — Pallavas (Rashtrakutas NAHI). [Q82]

2. Chausath Yogini Temple, Morena

- Morena (MP) ke pass ka gol/circular 'Chausath Yogini' temple, Kachchhapaghata dynasty ke Devapala ne ~1323 CE mein banwaya tha — ye Lord Shiva aur Yoginis ko dedicate hai (Vaishnavism se NAHI). Bahut log maante hain ki iska circular design purane Indian Parliament building ke liye inspiration bana. [Q9]

3. Temple Architecture Styles — Nagara, Dravida, Vesara & Panchayatan

- Independent freestanding stone-mortar shrines India mein Gupta period mein emerge hui thi. Ladkhan temple Badami Chalukyas se juda ek early structural example hai. Khajuraho ki khaasiyat hai ki uske temple compartments internally-externally seamlessly integrated hain. Kailashnath temple (Kanchi), Pallava rulers ne banwaya, Dravidian architecture ka mature example hai. [Q12]
- Teli ka Mandir (Gwalior) ek interesting architectural mix hai — surface decoration North Indian Nagara style se hai, lekin uska tall Shikhar (pinnacle) purely Dravidian style mein banaya gaya hai. [Q13]
- Hoysaleswara Temple (Halebidu, Karnataka), Vesara (hybrid) architecture style ka prime example hai — Hoysala rajaon ne dark schist se banaya, star-shaped base aur dense ornamental reliefs iski khaasiyat hain. [Q14]
- Nagara, Dravida aur Vesara — Indian temple architecture ki 3 main styles hain. Dravida style South India mein develop hui, Nagara North India mein, aur Vesara (Nagara+Dravida ka mix) mainly Deccan region mein milta hai. [Q95]
- 'Panchayatan' ek temple-construction style hai jisme ek central main shrine ko 4 chhote subsidiary shrines ghere rehte hain — naam Sanskrit ke 'Pancha' (paanch) aur 'Ayatana' (samahit) se aaya hai. Examples: Kandariya Mahadeo (Khajuraho), Brahmeshwar Temple, Lingaraja Temple (Bhubaneswar), Dashavatara Temple (Deogarh). [Q96]

4. World Heritage Sites of Ancient India

- Khajuraho, Bhimbetka rock shelters aur Sanchi Stupa — teeno UNESCO World Heritage Site hain. Mandu fort World Heritage Site NAHI hai. [Q11]

5. Buddhist Rock-cut Caves — Kanheri, Bagh & Related Sites

- Kanheri (Mumbai ke Borivali ke pass, west mein) mein 100 se zyada Buddhist caves hain — ~1st century BCE se shuru hoke, ye extensive rock-cut complex Buddhist devotional art aur structural elements dikhata hai. [Q15]
- Gupta period ke sirf 2 known cave-painting examples hain: Ajanta aur Bagh caves (MP). Bagh caves mein secular/rozmarra ki zindagi ke themes dikhaye gaye hain, Ajanta ke deeply Buddhist religious motifs se alag. (Lomas Rishi Mauryan period ki hai, Nasik ki caves Satavahanas ki hain.) [Q23]
- ⚠ Disputed: Sanchi aur Bulsar mein Buddhist CAVES nahi hain (Sanchi mein stupas hain, caves nahi) — lekin ye multiple-correct wala tricky question hai kyunki dono jagah technically options mein sahi hain. [Q52]

6. Jain Temples — Mount Abu, Palitana & Sonagiri

- Mount Abu ke famous Dilwara Temples Jain devotion ka masterpiece hain, पूरी तरह white marble se bane — Vimal Shah ne Chalukya king Bhimdev I ke patronage mein banwaye. Ye Rajasthan ke Aravalli mountain range mein situated hain, apni detailed marble carvings ke liye famous. [Q16, Q91, Q92, Q93]

- Palitana temple complex, Shatrunjaya hills par, Gujarat ke Bhavnagar district mein situated hai — mainly Adinatha (Jainism ke pehle Tirthankara) ko dedicate hai. [Q17]
- Sonagiri (Datia, MP se 15 km door), 103 Jain temples wali highest jagah hai — Digambar Jain devotees ke liye popular pilgrimage site hai. Temple No. 57 (Lord Chandraprabhu ko dedicate) main temple hai. [Q89, Q90]

7. Elephanta Caves

- Elephanta Caves (Arabian Sea ke ek island par, Rashtrakuta monarchs ne banwaye) mainly Shaiva devotees ke liye sculpted hain — Lord Shiva ko exclusively dedicate hain. Sabse iconic piece hai 'Trimurti' (Shiva ke cosmic roop ko darshane wali sculpture). [Q18, Q22]
- Elephanta ke ancient monuments mostly Shaivite hain (5 major Hindu shrines) — thoda Buddhist heritage bhi hai. Isliye Elephanta ka heritage Buddhist AUR Shaivite dono streams ko encapsulate karta hai. [Q19]
- Elephanta ke famous cave temples Rashtrakuta dynasty ke sovereigns ne banaye/fund kiye. Ellora aur Elephanta — dono sites apni primary architectural grandeur Rashtrakuta empire ke period mein pahunche the (Ellora Hindu-Buddhist-Jain teeno faiths ka mix hai, Elephanta sirf Shiva ki massive carvings ke liye famous hai). [Q20, Q21]

8. Ajanta & Ellora — Rock-cut Caves of Western India

- India ke Western region mein important rock-cut monuments Nasik, Ellora aur Ajanta mein hain (Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar/Aurangabad district, Maharashtra). Ellora complex mein 34 caves hain jo 3 religions celebrate karti hain; Nasik ki Pandavleni caves Buddhist art ke liye jaani jaati hain. [Q24, Q41, Q42, Q43]
- Ajanta Buddhist rock-cut caves aur fresco paintings ke liye exclusive repository hai — Elephanta (Shaiva art), Khajuraho (Hindu-Jain structural temples) aur Nalanda (brick-mortar university) se ye alag hai. [Q25]
- Ellora ke architectural excavations ka bada hissa mighty Rashtrakuta dynasty ne commission/nurture kiya tha. [Q26]
- Rock-cut architecture ke statements: Bhimbetka rock shelters, Badami caves se bhi purani hain (galat statement tha ki Badami purana hai). Barabar caves Mauryan Emperor Ashoka ne Ajivika sect ko dedicate ki thi, Chandragupta ne nahi (galat). Ellora sahi mein Buddhist, Hindu aur Jain — teeno faiths ke liye sanctuaries dikhata hai (sahi statement). [Q27]
- Ellora (Maharashtra) mein 34 structural excavations hain, jo Buddhist caves (1-12) se shuru hoke, Hindu temples (13-29) se hoke, Jain caves tak jaati hain — ye complete religious tolerance dikhata hai. Sirf Ellora hi ek jagah hai jaha Buddhist, Hindu aur Jain — teeno rock-cut systems ek saath coexist karte hain. [Q28, Q29, Q30]
- Ajanta ke art ko mainly Vakataka period mein patronize kiya gaya (ek earlier group Satavahana period mein bhi bani thi). Ye Buddhist cave temples hain jo mountain rock ko carve karke banaye gaye. [Q48]
- Ajanta caves Jataka stories se linked hain — inme Buddha ke previous janmo (Jataka tales) ko depict karne wali paintings hain, saath hi flowers/trees/animals ki bhi art hai. [Q49]

- Ajanta Caves, Waghora river ki gorge/valley mein situated hai (Chhatrapati Sambhaji Nagar dist., Maharashtra). Sanchi Stupa Betwa river ke west mein hai (Raisen dist., MP). Pandu-lena caves (Nasik) Godavari valley mein hain. Amravati Stupa Krishna river ke kinare hai (Palnadu dist., AP). [Q50]
- Mural paintings ka evidence Ajanta aur Lepakshi temple mein clearly milta hai, lekin Sanchi Stupa mein NAHI (jiska nucleus ek simple hemispherical brick structure tha, Buddha ke relics par bana, upar Chhatra symbol tha). [Q51]

9. The Kailasa Temple, Ellora & Rashtrakuta Patronage

- Kailasa Temple (Ellora) duniya bhar mein architectural wonder maana jaata hai — ek hi solid rock cliff ko chisel karke banaya gaya hai. Rashtrakuta king Krishna-I ne isse design/construct karwaya, Dravidian style mein. [Q31, Q32, Q33, Q34, Q35, Q36, Q37, Q38, Q39]
- Rashtrakuta rulers Shaiva, Vaishnava aur Shakta bhakto ko patronize karte the, lekin unka jhukav sabse zyada Jainism ki taraf tha — unke darbar ke kai scholars (Sanskrit, Kannada, Apabhramsha, Prakrit likhne wale) Jain the. King Amoghavarsha-I khud ek Jain Acharya ke shishya the. [Q40]

10. Gupta Period Temples

- Gupta Temple match: Brick-built Temple → Bhitargaon (Kanpur); Dasavatara Temple → Deogarh (Lalitpur); Shiva Temple → Bhumara; Vishnu Temple → Eran. [Q44]
- Deogarh (Jhansi ke pass) ka temple aur Garhwa (Allahabad ke pass) ki sculptures — dono Gupta art ke important remains hain. Dashavatar temple (Deogarh) North India ka sabse purana known Panchayatan temple hai. [Q45, Q46]
- Bhitargaon (Kanpur, UP) ka temple ek terraced brick building hai, terracotta panels ke saath — 5th-6th century AD (Gupta period) mein bana. Ye India ke sabse purane brick temples mein se ek hai, square plan par bana, double-recessed corners ke saath, purab (east) ki taraf face karta hai, garbhagriha ke upar tall pyramidal spire hai. [Q47]

11. Konark & Other Sun Temples

- Konark Sun Temple (13th century, Odisha) King Narasimhadeva Varman-I (Eastern Ganga Dynasty) ne banwaya tha — ek huge solar chariot ki tarah design kiya gaya, 12 pairs ornamental wheels aur 7 ghode kheenchte hue. European sailors ise 'Black Pagoda' kehte the (Puri ka Jagannath Temple 'White Pagoda' kehlaata tha). [Q56, Q57, Q58, Q59]
- Sun Temple of Modhera (Patan district, Gujarat) Solanki dynasty ke King Bhimadeva-I ne banwaya tha. [Q60, Q61]
- Arasavalli (Andhra Pradesh) apne prominent 7th-century Sun temple ke liye famous hai, jo King Devendra Varma (Eastern Ganga Dynasty) ne banwaya tha. (Omkareshwar Shiva ka Jyotirlinga hai, Amarkantak Narmada ke origin aur Shiva temple ke liye — dono Sun temples ke liye NAHI famous hain.) [Q86]

12. Odisha Temples — Lingaraj & Jagannath Puri

- Lingaraj Temple (Bhubaneswar, Odisha) Lord Shiva ko dedicate hai (unhe 'Lingaraj' bhi kehte hain) — ~180 feet ooncha hai, Nagara style mein bana hai, aur Odisha ka sabse bada-sabse ooncha surviving temple hai. [Q62, Q63]
- Jagannath Temple, Odisha (Puri) mein hai — Lingaraj temple aur Konarka Sun Temple bhi Odisha mein hain, dono Nagara style mein bane. Bhubaneswara (Lingaraja) aur Puri (Jagannath) ke temples — dono Nagara architecture style mein bane hain. [Q64, Q65]
- Jagannath Puri Temple mein Lord Jagannath, Subhadra aur Balbhadra ki idols neem (nimb) wood se banayi jaati hain — Bhavishya Purana ke mutabik neem wood Vishnu idols ke liye sabse shubh maana jaata hai. Ye idol Ratha-yatra se pehle har saal repaint hoti hai, aur har 12-19 saal mein Hindu calendar ke hisaab se replace bhi hoti hai. [Q66]

13. Southeast Asian Temples — Angkor Wat & Borobudur

- Angkor Wat Vishnu Temple, Cambodia (Kampuchea) mein hai — Khmer King Suryavarman-II ne 12th century ke shuruat mein apni capital mein banwaya. Ye Khmer style mein bana duniya ka sabse bada Hindu temples ka group hai, Lord Vishnu ko dedicate. [Q67, Q68, Q69]
- Borobudur Stupa, Java (Indonesia) mein situated hai — ek massive Mahayana Buddhist temple, UNESCO World Heritage Site hai. [Q70]

14. Dravidian Architecture — The Gopuram

- 'Gopuram' Dravidian style ke temples ki entrance par bana ek ornate, monumental tower hota hai — South Indian Hindu temples ki khaasiyat hai. Iska origin Tamil kings Pallavas se trace hota hai, aur ye ornamental multi-storied gateways temple ke bahar dikhne ki ek dominant feature ban gaye. [Q71]

15. Mahabalipuram — Pallava Rock-cut Architecture

- Mahabalipuram (Mamallapuram) ke rock-cut temples Pallava king Narasimha Varman ne banwaye — Shore temple, Rathas (single rock se carved chariots), Arjuna's Penance jaise wonders yahan hain. Ye UNESCO World Heritage Monument hai. [Q72, Q73, Q76]
- Seven Ratha Temple (Sapt Pagoda), Mahabalipuram mein, Narasimha Varman-I (630-668 AD) ne banwaya — unhi ke naam par Mamallapuram (Mahabalipuram) sheher ka naam pada, aur unke time 'Mamalla' style develop hui. [Q74, Q75]
- Draupadi Rath sabse chhota Ratha temple hai Mahabalipuram mein — simple hut-jaisa structure hai, koi elaborate ornamentation nahi, lion-elephant sculptures par tika hua hai. [Q77]
- Kailasanathar Temple (Kanchipuram), Pallava king Narasimhavarman II (Rajasimha) ne banwaya — 'Rajsimha' architectural style mein, jisme intricate carvings, bade Gopurams aur stone sculptures hote hain. [Q78]

- Temples ka chronological order: Sapt Pagoda (Mamalla style, ~640-674 AD) → Shore Temple (Rajasimha style, ~700-728 AD) → Brihdeeshwara temple (Chola King Rajaraja I, ~1003-1010 AD) → Gangaikonda Cholapuram temple (Rajendra I, ~1035 AD). [Q79]
- Ajanta aur Mahabalipuram mein common cheez hai: dono rock-cut monuments hain. (Dono ek hi religion se related nahi hain — Mahabalipuram Hindu/Shiva-Vishnu se related hai, Ajanta poori tarah Buddhist hai.) [Q54]

16. Important Site-Monument Match Lists

- Match: Stupa → Sanchi (MP); Cave paintings → Bagh (MP); Kanishka's headless statue → Mathura (UP); Dashavatara Temple → Deogarh (UP). [Q10]
- Match: Hampi → Karnataka; Nagarjunakonda → Andhra Pradesh; Shishupalgarh → Odisha; Arikamedu → Puducherry. [Q55]
- Match: Elephanta → Cave (rock-cut Shiva caves); Shravanabelagola → Statue (Gommateshwara Bahubali); Khajuraho → Temple (Chandela-built); Sanchi → Stupa (Ashoka ka Great Stupa). [Q80]
- Match: Bhimbetka (Rock Shelters) → Madhya Pradesh; Shore Temple (Mahabalipuram) → Tamil Nadu; Hampi (Vijayanagara ruins) → Karnataka; Manas (Wildlife Sanctuary) → Assam. [Q81]
- Match: Baidyanath Dham (Deoghar) → Shiva Temple (12 Jyotirlingas mein se ek); Sarnath (Varanasi) → Buddha ka pehla sermon (Dharmachakra Pravartan); Dilwara (Mount Abu) → Jain Temple (marble carvings); Badrinath → Vishnu Temple (Shankaracharya ne establish kiya). [Q83]
- Pairs check: Besnagar Shaivite cave shrine ke liye NAHI, balki Heliodorus Pillar (Bhagavat/Vaishnav religion) ke liye famous hai (galat pair). Bhaja Caves (Pune) Buddhist rock-cut architecture ke liye famous hain (sahi). Sittanavasal (Tamil Nadu) Jain cave shrine-paintings ke liye famous hai, Pallavas ne banwaya (sahi). Isliye 2 pairs sahi hain. [Q84]
- Match: Sun Temple → Konark (Odisha); Lingaraja Temple → Bhubaneswar (Harihara/Shiva ko dedicate); Hawa Mahal → Jaipur (Rajasthan); Statue of Gomateshwara (Bahubali) → Shravanabelagola (Karnataka). [Q85]
- Match: Nalanda → University (higher learning ka centre); Sarnath → Ashoka Pillar (Lion Capital); Sanchi → Stupa (Great Stupa); Konark → Sun Temple (Black Pagoda). [Q87]
- Statements check: Cave 26 (Ajanta) mein Buddha ka 'Mahaparinirvana' statue engrave hai (sahi). Varaha Avatar ki huge rock-cut statue Udaygiri caves (MP) mein hai, Mount Abu mein NAHI (galat). 'Arjuna's Penance' (Descent of Ganga) Mahabalipuram (Tamil Nadu) mein hai, huge boulders par sculpted. [Q98]

17. Miscellaneous Historic Sites

- Ancient town Takshashila (Taxila), Indus aur Jhelum river ke beech situated thi — 6th/7th century BC mein establish hui, aaj ke Rawalpindi district (Pakistan) mein, learning ka famous centre thi. [Q88]
- Famous Virupaksha Temple Hampi (Karnataka) mein hai — Lord Shiva ko (Virupaksha roop mein) dedicate hai, Vijayanagara Empire ke time bana. [Q94]
- Naimisharanya (famous pilgrimage) Sitapur district, UP mein hai — Hindu mythology ke mutabik yahin Sage Dadhichi ne apni haddiyan Devon ko de di thi, jinse Indra ka 'Vajra' weapon bana. [Q97]

- ⚠️ Disputed: Chitrakoot (famous Hindu pilgrimage), UP-MP dono states ki border par phaila hai — Kamadgiri hill (jaha Lord Kamata Nath rehte hain) ka kuch hissa UP mein aur kuch MP mein hai, isliye 'kis state mein hai' wala question ambiguous hai (BPSC ne MP accept kiya tha). [Q99]
- Diye gaye options mein sabse purana rock-cut art hai Dhauli (Odisha) ka Rock-cut Elephant — Ashoka ke time (3rd century BC) ka. Udayagiri ka Varaha image 5th century AD (Gupta) ka hai, Mahabalipuram ke rock-cut monuments Pallavas ne 7th-8th century AD mein banaye, aur Lingaraja Temple 10th-11th century AD mein bana — sabse baad mein. [Q100]

18. Folk Paintings of India

- ⚠️ Note: 'Pattachitra' Odisha ki folk art hai, Lord Jagannath aur Vaishnav cults se judi hai. 'Manjusha' art Bhagalpur (Bihar) ki folk art hai — Manjushas mandir-jaise boxes hote hain, 8 pillars ke saath, India ki sabse purani painting arts mein se ek. 'Pithora' painting Gujarat-MP ke tribes ki ritualistic painting hai. [Q53]